

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Post-Rio to Retirement

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I'll return now to about 1968 and include some of the activities in which our family was engaged during the period of time that I was in the Personnel Management Staff as related in the foregoing chapter (TEN).

In July 1968, I rented a cabin from Hugh Tovar in Seven Springs, Pennsylvania. It was a nice cabin in the woods and near a lot of recreational facilities. It rained some of the time that we were there but we had brought books and games in case of such an occurrence and enjoyed the relaxation. We went swimming in a pool with a very high slide and a little beach. Hilton, Patty and I went fishing and got Hilton hooked on being a fisherman. Most of the family went horseback riding as well and were extremely stiff after not having done this before or, at least, for a long time. We held our own sacrament and testimony meeting and it was a very special occasion for the family.

During the summer we bought a piece of land at a place called Lake of the Woods, which was about a 75 minute drive from McLean. The lake was man-made but contained about 500 acres of water. As a bribe for purchasing a waterfront lot, we were "given" a little Snark sailboat and the family really enjoyed getting involved in sailing as well as some of the other amenities available, such as golfing, swimming, and fishing. We even had the entire McLean Ward down there for a ward outing the following summer. As it turned out we never did build on the site, although we had some intentions of doing so.

As I have mentioned in other parts of this history, 1968 was a violent year in the United States. Opposition to the Vietnam War cause a lot of demonstrations but other things occurred which contributed to the national trauma. Martin Luther King, the civil rights leader, was assassinated on April 4 in Memphis, causing riots in various cities in the United States, including Washington, D.C. Then on June 5th, U. S. Senator Robert F. Kennedy was shot and mortally wounded in Los Angeles while on a campaign trip.

In August Soviet troops invaded Czechoslovakia, to end Alexander Dubcek's liberal reforms and the Soviet Bloc continued to strengthen itself with the addition of this former stalwart from the ranks of the democratic nations. All of this contributed to a vicious election campaign which was won in November by Richard M. Nixon, former Vice-President under Eisenhower.

Late in 1968, while she was in her Senior year at Langley High in Virginia, Gail had quite a rude awakening. She wanted to go the BYU but found that it wouldn't accept

her because her grades were too low, due to the considerable goofing off she had down while we were in Rio de Janeiro. She then decided she would go to another school away from home whose requirements weren't so high. We explained that we couldn't afford to send her away other than to the Y, since we also had Ron on a mission. Living at home and attending a local college was the last thing that she wanted to do at this stage of her life, so she buckled down and raised her grades sufficient to where the Y would accept her on a probationary basis.

Some years ago Milan Smith, President of the Washington D.C. Stake had the foresight to push for a location for eventual construction of a temple in the Washington, D.C. area. One was finally purchased and we spent some of our Saturdays cleaning brush and debris from this site which was on a hill in Kensington, Md. In December 1968, Hugh. B. Brown of the First Presidency and other dignitaries, such as Julian Lowe, Milan Smith, and J. Willard Marriott, participated in a ground-breaking ceremony which was pretty well attended in spite of it being a cold, bitter day. Construction on the temple didn't start immediately but it was finished in 1974.

In early 1969, I needed to get some foundation in Statistics because of the work that I was doing for the Personnel Management Staff, so the Agency sent me to a night course in that subject at American University in Washington, D.C. It was quite a challenge to me since it had been a long time since I had attended any formal classes at a university and even longer since I had to do any Algebra. I made out all right in it, even though I suffered an age handicap.

In July, 1969, Pam Jeppsen, came to visit us. During her stay we went camping on our lot at Lake of the Woods and it was while we were there that Neil Armstrong and Edwin Aldrin became the first men to walk on the moon (July 20). There were several large television screens set up at the main lodge so that people could witness this spectacular occurrence. In August of that year, we also went to the pageant at the Hill Cumorah, the first time that Hilton had had an opportunity to be with us. We also had a visit this year from our friends Matt and Vivian Olson, whom we knew at the Y and also in the Alexandria Ward.

In 1970 I started experiencing some problems with my back. I don't know how or what happened to cause the pain in my lower spine but I spent a lot of time with doctors, initially with a chiropractor, Moir Bowman, who eventually admitted that there wasn't much more he could do for me and I took my X-rays to an orthopedic surgeon who sent me for a lot of physical therapy work, none of which was ever very effective.

In late 1969 and early 1970, some friends of mine were active in the formation of a land development company called Growth Land. Initially, my interest was as a stock holder since I had, along with my brother, Martin, purchased a block of the unregistered shares. Later, however, as a result of the enthusiasm attached to the home-building concept of a small Utah company called Research Homes, Growth Land merged with Research Homes and formed a nationwide company. Unfortunately, I got too involved in the activities of the company and its principal officers (mainly because of a promise to hire me upon my early retirement for which I was eligible in 1972). I sold much of the letter stock to a lot of friends of mine in the company (about \$250,000 worth) which probably would have been great had the company succeeded. One of the major projects of Research Homes was a development known as Crows Nest Harbour. It was under construction in Stafford County about sixty miles from Washington, D.C. In addition to the stock of Research Homes, I got involved, along with a number of my CIA associates, in the purchase of some two acre lots at the Crows Nest Harbour project which was located at the confluence of the Potomac River and Potomac Creek, an area rich in tradition. It was said that this was the area where Captain John Smith romanced Pocahontas, the Indian princess.

I organized a small sub-chapter S corporation along with Ken Hampton, Tom Robertson and Jim Burson, the latter two colleagues of mine at C.I.A. We planned to sub-divide the four lots which we purchased contiguously (a total of more than eight acres) into one-half acre home sites. This never did materialized due to the failure of some of the projects and the eventual demise of Research Homes in 1974.

Hilton was very involved in Boy's Club football during this year. He belonged to a team called the Chinese Bandits and it won the championship that year. He demonstrated a lot of speed even though he was tall and lanky for his nine years of age. He continued to play football in this league for several seasons.

During the summer of 1971, a girl named Dorrie Nelson came to spend the summer with us while she worked in Washington, D.C. She was a beautiful girl and very gracious and we enjoyed having her with us. The only problem we encountered was with boy friends, who would date her and then spend hours saying goodbye. She eventually married Michael Sherrill. They live in California and we exchange Christmas greetings with them every year although we haven't seen them for many years.

In spite of my busy schedule at work, I managed to get to the Father's and Son's outings with Hilton, as I had with Ron when we were in the States. In 1971, Hilton and I started a tradition of carving our initials in a special tree down in Prince William forest and having a

talk and a prayer together. We drew a map so that each year we could locate the particular tree which was special to us. By the time we left Virginia, however, the tree's bark had peeled quite a bit from the growth.

When we were first in the Alexandria Ward, our bishop was a man named Wendell Thorne. His wife was named Harriet. They lived right across the street from the Gerald Ford family and took care of some of their children for them. In October 1971 the Thornes decided to move to Florida and Frank and Lela Kimball held a special going away party at their house for the Thornes. Besides us the George Goolds and the O'Bryants were there to say Bon Voyage to the Thornes.

My sister, Loverna, passed away in December 1971. All of the children except her youngest, Kenny, were either married or out on their own. We decided to take Kenny into our home in Virginia and he got there to start school just after Christmas. It was pretty difficult for him to adjust to a new area and find new friends, although we tried to help him out as much as possible. He finished out the remainder of the school year and then decided to return to California to stay with a family that he had known for a longer period of time. It worked out all right and Kenny is now working for the Forestry Service and is married and has a family of three daughters. Unfortunately, after he returned to California he became inactive in the Church and still won't have anything to do with it.

The most eventful and far-reaching thing that occurred in 1972 didn't involve anything that I did but I am recording it in my history so that my posterity will know that I was in the Washington, D.C. area at the time that it took place. Five burglars were arrested on June 17, 1972 in the Democratic National Committees headquarters at the Watergate office building in Washington, D.C. They were later identified as hirelings of the Committee to Reelect the President (Nixon) and began an affair which resulted in Nixon nearly being impeached in 1974 and led to his subsequent resignation. My interest was somewhat personal in that one of the persons behind the scene in this affair was Edward Howard Hunt who was the C.I.A. Station Chief in Montevideo during my tour there. Those of us at the Agency at the time (Hunt had already left the Agency by then) were initially just amused since we knew that Howard Hunt didn't have any special talents for surreptitious entry. Certainly not based upon his experience with the Agency. Although some operations required such attempts while Howard was the Station Chief in Montevideo, he was not directly involved.

During 1973 I had continuing problems with my back and tried almost every doctor I could. In January of that year an acupuncture clinic opened in Washington, D.C. Since it was supervised by an M.D. and the acupuncturists were

doctors trained in Taiwan, I decided to try it. I suppose I went to about six sessions and, although relaxing, the upshot was that my back still bothered me. However, they did successfully cure a bad case of bursitis that I had in my left shoulder. It was interesting to see how many people, desperate to get relief, came from all over the northeast area of the U. S. It did some of them some good and had become popular because during Nixon's visit to China, a journalist for the New York Times (Reston) had had to have emergency surgery while in China and acupuncture was the accepted anesthetic for him.

This year I continued making mistakes in my investments, having put about \$10,000 in 1970 in Research Homes, which by this time was pretty shaky. One of the members of the Church that I had known for quite a long time and who had been a Bishop of the Arlington Ward, started a business called PO-JO where pinball machines were used to play golf (using golf's scoring method) and using billiard balls. The business failed miserably and I lost about \$5000.

In April we flew out to the West for Ron's wedding to Diana Farrell. We initially went to Salt Lake and Provo then took Rhoda Jones' car to San Clemente, California, Diana's home. They were married on April 25, 1973 in the Los Angeles temple. Ron and Gail also graduated from college in May 1973 and Ron was accepted into the charter class of the new J. Rueben Clark Law School at B.Y.U.

Although limited in my activity because of my disability, I had already been contacted prior to my retirement on June 30, 1973 by Leadership Systems, Inc, a management firm located in Silver Spring, Maryland. Leadership Systems used people like me as consultants and counselors for a skill discovery workshop, to help individuals discover for themselves the leadership skills and abilities which they had or might develop to make themselves more effective in their chosen careers. I worked for LSI somewhat sporactically from July 1973 up to the time that we decided to move to Arizona. Most of the clientel were organizations of the U. S. Government such as Small Business Adminstration, U. S. Forest Service, Office of Education, Bureau of Mines, Dept. of Labor, General Service Adminstration, the Army Materiel Command, the Environmental Protection Agency and the Federal Aviation Adminstration. Working with these various segments of the government provided me with an opportunity to learn about and gain some insights as to the problems, activities and attitudes involved in various government entities. Although having worked for the government in C.I.A, I knew little about other components except for those involved someway or another in military , foreign service or intelligence activities. It certainly helped me to broaden my perspective of what was going on in the U. S. Government and I really

got a better insight as to the dedication of many government employees. Many of these people gave up potentially good careers in the academic world or in business in order to serve their country and regrettably often don't get the recognition for the sacrifices they make.

As a result of my long involvement with the company and upon insistence of several large stockholders, I was elected to serve as a member of the Board of Directors of Research Homes, Inc. in November of 1973. I didn't have much of a chance to contribute any of my practical experience to the company, however. By this time the company was in very serious financial difficulties for several reasons. In October, O.P.E.C. (the Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries), had begun the curtailment of oil shipments to industrial nations and a major energy crisis developed. It soon had its effect on companies that were in the land development business, especially when they owned parcels of land which required a lot of automobile travel to reach, such as the Crows Nest Harbor development, the major project of RHI. It required more than an hour's travel from Washington, D. C.

For Christmas 1973 we reversed the usual process wherein the college kids flew back to Virginia for the holidays. Instead, since Ron, his wife Diana, Gail, and Pat were all at the Y, we (Marion, Hilton and I) took a student charter plane arranged by students of Eastern universities returning home to the Utah area for the holidays.

From 1970 to 1973 I served as the Sunday School President of the McLean Ward, having been released as the High Priest Group leader. I had Hal Milner and Amos Wright (a retired Army colonel) as my assistants. In those days the Sunday School superintendent (or president) had a lot more to do with staffing the organization than he does today. The president was also directly responsible for the Jr. Sunday School, headed by a Jr. Sunday School coordinator, which in our case was Nola Lowe, Julian Lowes's wife. This was one of the most enjoyable assignments I have ever had since I particularly loved visiting the classes of the small children. On one occasion we decided to have each member of the class of four year olds bring a Christmas present to donate to some unfortunate child (not in the Church). I was thrilled at the faces of the children as they placed their presents in the bag for us to take to the needy children. It is something that I will always remember since their faces showed that they felt that they were really sharing and feeling the spirit of Christmas, and any parent or grandparent knows how four-year olds love the thoughts of Christmas.

The year 1974 didn't start out very well. After making the rounds of all kinds of doctors, chiropractors, osteopaths, neurologists, acupuncturists, and orthopedic

surgeons, I finally was convinced that I needed to have surgery done on my back. So in January 1974 I underwent a double laminectomy on sacrolumbar disks L4 and L5. The surgery went O.K. and it appeared for several months that it had been successful. However, it is something which I regret having done.

Early in February and as part of my convalescence, I went on a cruise to the West Indies on a yacht owned by James W. Dyer, Chairman of the Board of Research Homes, Inc., who having made several million dollars on a previous stock venture of a toy company, liked the good life. I had known Jim since my days in the Alexandria Ward bishopric in 1955, when Jim was selling Renoware from door-to-door. There were several other officers of the company with us and ostensibly the cruise was to let them get away and think about the future of the company which was in very sad straits. Regretably not much of real problem-solving took place. I enjoyed the cruise and the visit to such fabled places as Martinique but I could tell that my back problem was still with me by the time we returned. One favorable factor of the trip was that I made some money on the sale of some bags of silver coins which I had purchased on margin during the summer of 1973 and which reached a then record price in early Feb. 1974. As I recall I made a profit of about \$11,000, thinking that I would sell half of my holdings since I would be out of touch for a week or so and in this case my timing was perfect. The day after I sold five bags of coins, the market turned around and dropped a dollar per ounce of silver.

During this year I continued doing some consulting work for Leadership Systems, Inc. although my activities were cut back quite a bit. Theral O'Bryant and I did a workshop together with the air controllers at the Leesburg, Virginia center and I learned a lot about the stresses and strains connected with that activity. I did some traveling as well to places like Kansas City and Dallas. The only vacation that the family had was one at Rehobeth Beach in Maryland where we and the O'Bryants rented a cabin owned by the sister of Ells Knudson, a member of the McLean Ward. We had a good time at the beach although quite a bit of the time was spent reading and playing party games due to rainy weather.

In the Fall of 1974, the long-awaited completion came to the Washington, D.C. temple. We were all very much engaged in activities involved in the dedication which took place on November 20, 1974. Marion, particularly, worked with a group which was responsible for the distribution of tickets and it was a very demanding calling. There was a

film made of the events surrounding the dedication of the temple and the work of the ticket group was included. If one can get to see it they would see Marion in the film. We both served as guides in various parts of the temple which required us to learn certain facts and data about the temple as well as give information on the church. Of course, it was mandatory that the temple be staffed and I was called as an officiator at the temple. Marion was not called because we still had a child at home. I served in this capacity until shortly before we left for Arizona in 1975.